

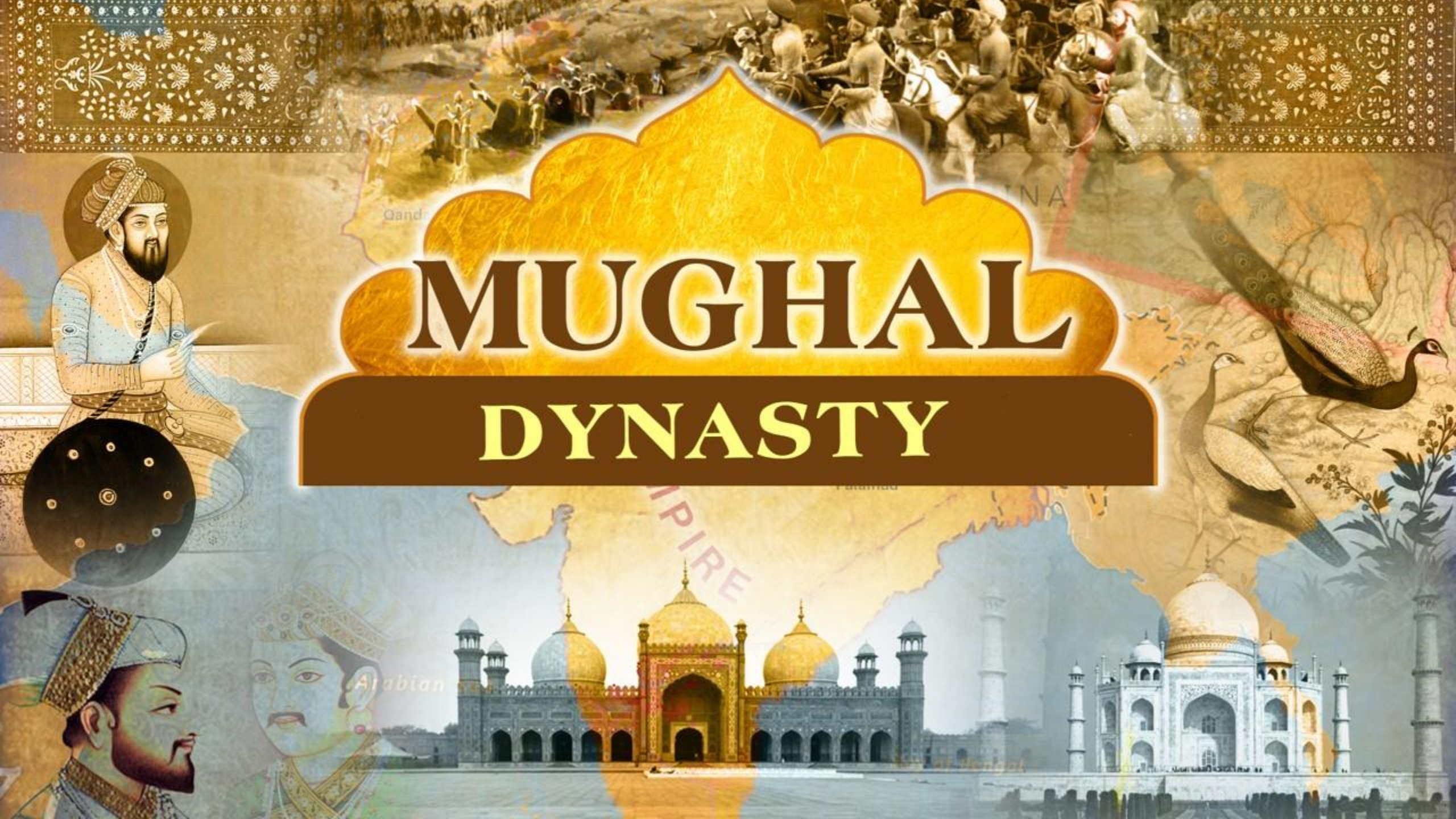
MEDIEVAL HISTORY



MODULE - 29

MUGHAL DYNASTY
AURANGZEB-PART 2

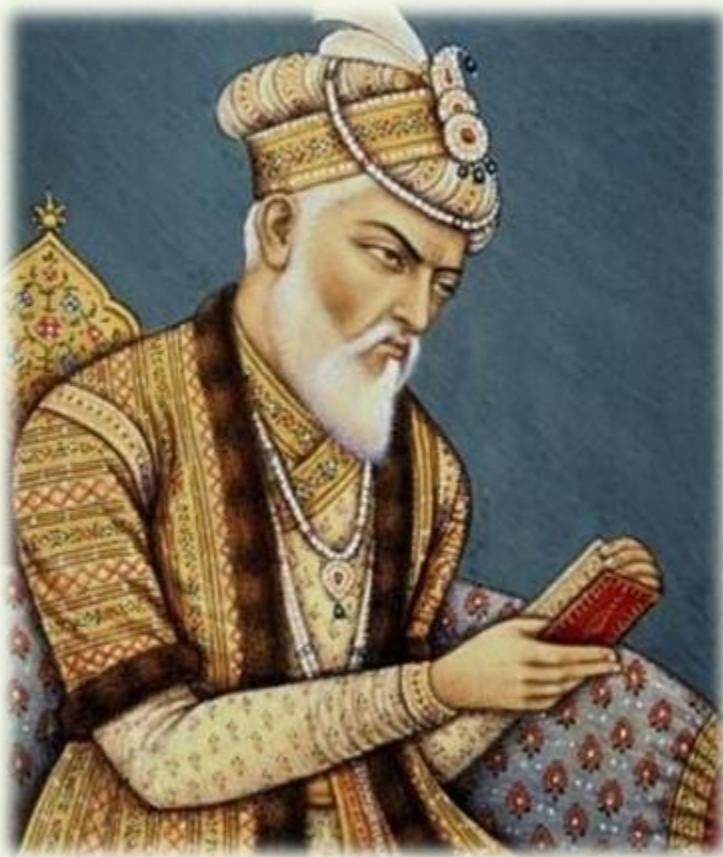




MUGHAL DYNASTY

AURANGZEB (1658 AD- 1707 AD)

RELIGIOUS POLICY AND REBELIONS UNDER AURANGZEB



1 Various rebellions took place during his reign due to his harsh religious policy.

2 Aurangzeb was a staunch and orthodox Muslim in his personal life and his vision was to transform India into an Islamic state.

3 Initially,
▪ Aurangzeb banned the construction of new Hindu temples and the repair of old temples

4 Later he gradually started destroying Hindu temples. Eg:
▪ The temple of Keshava Rai at Mathura (built by Bir Singh Deo Bundela in the reign of Jahangir) was destroyed
▪ the Vishwanath temple at Banaras were reduced to ruins.

5 In 1679 AD, he reimposed jiziya and pilgrim tax.

MUGHAL DYNASTY

AURANGZEB (1658 AD- 1707 AD)

RELIGIOUS POLICY AND REBELIONS UNDER AURANGZEB



- 1 He was also not tolerant of other Muslim sects.
- 2 The celebration of Muharram was stopped. In fact, his invasions against the Deccan sultanates were partly due to his deep dislike towards the Shia faith.
- 3 In 1675 AD, he executed the ninth Sikh Guru, Tegh Bahadur, which resulted in the rebellion of the Sikh community against him.
- 4 He gave excessive powers to the office of Muhtasib, the officer entrusted to enforce moral codes.

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RELIGIOUS POLICY AND REBELIONS UNDER AURANGZEB



- 5 Throughout his kingdom,
 - drinking was prohibited
 - cultivation and the use of bhang and other drugs were banned.
- 6 He also forbade music in the Mughal court and discontinued the practice of Jharokha darshan (as he considered it a superstitious practice and against Islam)

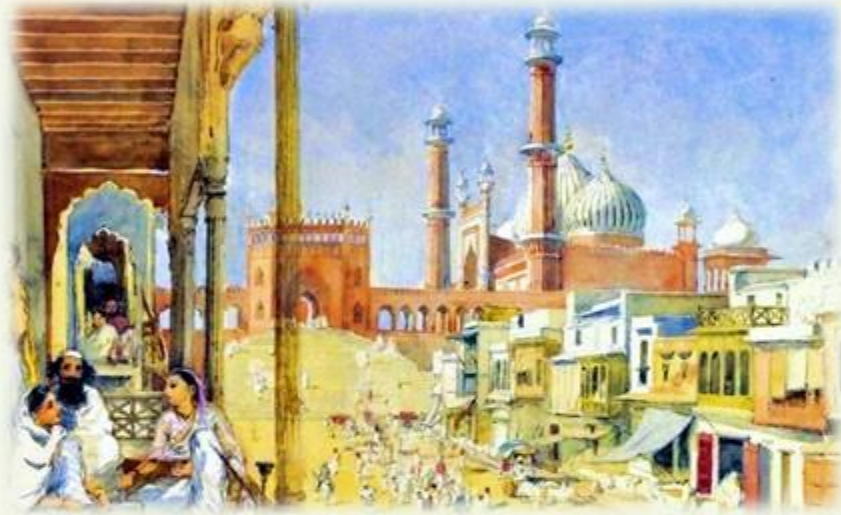
NOTE :

Interestingly the largest number of Persian works on classical Indian music were written in Aurangzeb's reign and that Aurangzeb himself was proficient in playing the veena.

MUGHAL DYNASTY

AURANGZEB (1658 AD- 1707 AD)

RELIGIOUS POLICY AND REBELIONS UNDER AURANGZEB



OTHER DIRECTIONS ISSUED BY AURANGZEB

- Stopped the system of weighing the emperor in gold
- Prohibited the celebration of Dasarah
- Forbade astrologers from preparing almanacs
- Forbade the use of Kalma inscribed on his coins
- Abolished Nauroz (as it was a Zoroastrian practice favoured by the Safavid rulers of Iran)
- He also forbade Forcefull Sati.

MUGHAL DYNASTY

AURANGZEB (1658 AD- 1707 AD)

RELIGIOUS POLICY AND REBELIONS UNDER AURANGZEB



SECULAR DECREES

- It is also believed that he had also issued secular decrees, called zawabit.
- Largest number of Persian works on classical Indian music were written in Aurangzeb's reign.

MUGHAL DYNASTY

AURANGZEB (1658 AD- 1707 AD)

POINTS TO REMEMBER ABOUT AURANGZEB



- 1 Aurangzeb's Rajput policy alienated the Rajputs and they gradually lost their position in the administrative set up.
- 2 Aurangzeb's policy towards Marwar and Mewar was clumsy and full of blunders and brought no advantage of any kind to the Mughals.
- 3 He wanted to divide the Marwar state between the two principal claimants, and in the process alienated both.

MUGHAL DYNASTY

AURANGZEB (1658 AD- 1707 AD)

POINTS TO REMEMBER ABOUT AURANGZEB

PERSONALITY TRAITS OF AURANGZEB



- 1 In his private life, Aurangzeb was industrious, disciplined, was very simple in food, dressing, and did not at all consume wine.
- 2 He was learned and proficient in Arabic and Persian languages and was a great lover of books.
- 3 He patronised the greatest digest of Muslim law in India, *Fatwa-i-Alamgiri*.
- 4 He was highly devoted to his religion and conducted prayers five times a day, strictly observing the Ramzan fasting.

MUGHAL DYNASTY

AURANGZEB (1658 AD- 1707 AD)

POINTS TO REMEMBER ABOUT AURANGZEB

PERSONALITY TRAITS OF AURANGZEB



- 5 In fact, he earned money for his personal expenses by copying the Quran and selling those copies. Due to all these qualities, he was called Darvesh/ Zindapir (a living saint).
- 6 He had constructed the Moti Masjid at Delhi and the Badshahi Mosque at Lahore.
- 7 Aurangzeb adopted an effective revenue system at Bengal and appointed Murshid Quli Khan as Diwan of Bengal.

MOTI MASJID



BADSHAHI MOSQUE



MUGHAL DYNASTY

AURANGZEB (1658 AD- 1707 AD)

POINTS TO REMEMBER ABOUT AURANGZEB

FAMOUS LITERARY FIGURES DURING AURANGAZEB'S REIGN



DARA SHIKOH

- He was a great scholar
- He wrote Majma-ul-Bahrain
- Translated the Upanishads and Bhagvat Gita
- Wrote Safinat-ul-auliya, Sainat-ul-Auliya, Hasanat-ul-Arifin.

MIRZA MOHD. QASIM - wrote *Alamgirnama*

ISHWAR DAS NAGAR: wrote *Fatuh-i-alamgiri*

NIMAT KHAN ALI: wrote *Wakai-i-Hyderabad*, the conquest of Golconda by Aurangzeb.

MUGHAL DYNASTY

AURANGZEB (1658 AD- 1707 AD)

TRADE AND COMMERCE

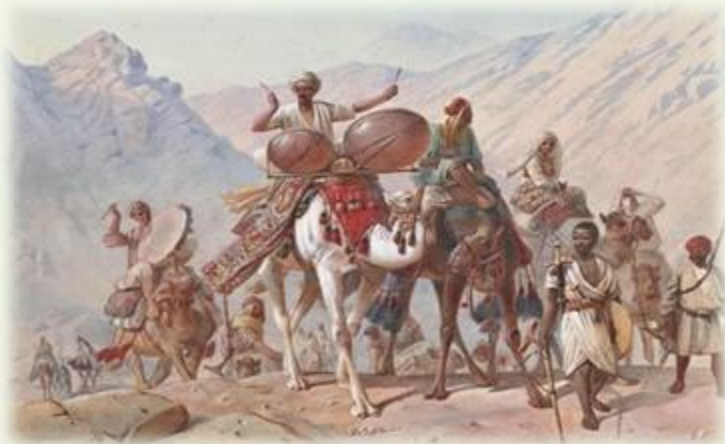


- 1 The Indian trading classes were large in numbers, well-spread throughout the country and were well organised and highly professional.
- 2 Seth, bohra traders specialised in long distance trade while local traders were called *Banik*.
- 3 Another class of traders known as *Banjaras*, were specialised in carrying bulk goods and used to move to long distances with their goods on the back of oxen.

MUGHAL DYNASTY

AURANGZEB (1658 AD- 1707 AD)

TRADE AND COMMERCE



4 Interestingly, the trading community did not belong to one caste or religion.

For instance,

- The **Gujarati merchants** included Hindus, Jains, and Muslims,
- In **Rajasthan Oswals, Maheshwaris, and Agarwals** came to be called the **Marwaris**
- In south India, the **Chettis** on the **Coramandal coast** and the **Muslim merchants of Malabar** formed important trading communities.

MUGHAL DYNASTY

AURANGZEB (1658 AD- 1707 AD)

TRADE AND COMMERCE



5 India, during the Mughal period, witnessed further intensification of her foreign trade owing to the advent of the European trading companies and their direct participation in the Euro-Asian and Intra-Asian trade.

6 India had trade relations with central Asia, Persia, and Europe.

7 Her major export included

- Textiles
- Saltpetre
- Sugar
- Opium
- spices.

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AURANGZEB (1658 AD- 1707 AD)

TRADE AND COMMERCE



8 In comparison to her export, her imports were limited to select commodities like

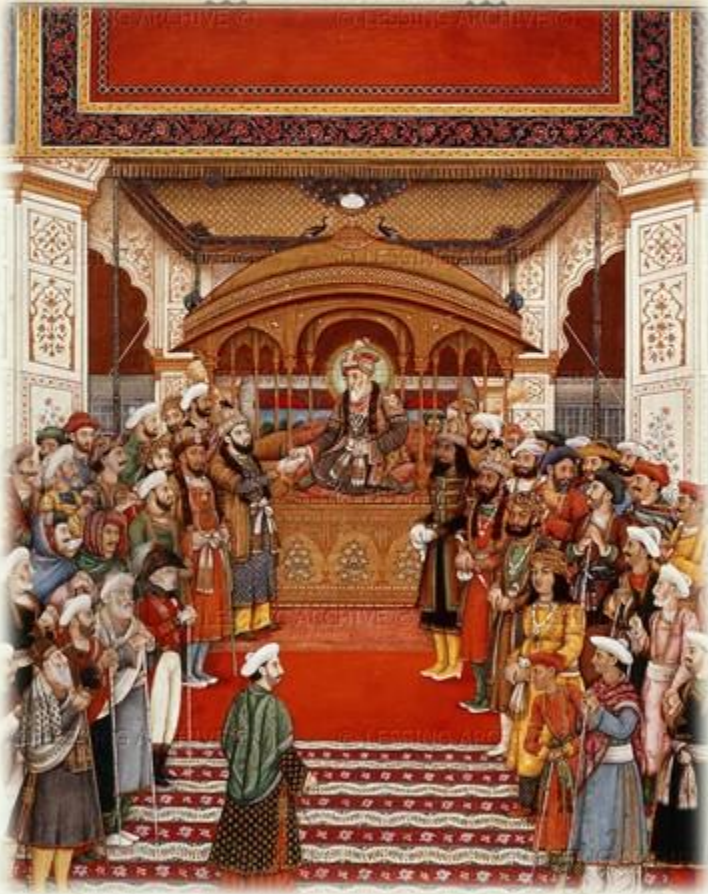
- War horses
- Luxury items such as ivory, silver, silk, porcelain,, carpets, perfume, watches, silver utensils
- Good quality wine
- Glass
- Tin and copper

9 Banjaras were traders who specialized in carrying bulk goods. They used to move long distances with their goods on the back of oxen. Bulk goods were taken on rivers using boats.

MUGHAL DYNASTY

AURANGZEB (1658 AD- 1707 AD)

ROBUST FINANCIAL SYSTEM



- 1 The movement of goods occurred through a complex network, linking wholesalers with merchants down to the regional and local levels through agents (*gumashtas*) and commission agents (dalals).
- 2 The movement of goods was also facilitated by the growth of a financial system which permitted easy transmission of money from one part of the country to another.
- 3 This was done through the use of *hundis*, a paper document promising payment of money after a fixed period of time at a discount and certain place.

MUGHAL DYNASTY

AURANGZEB (1658 AD- 1707 AD)

ROBUST FINANCIAL SYSTEM



- 4 The hundis often included insurance which was charged at different rates on the basis of value of the goods, destination, means of transport (land, river, or sea), etc.
- 5 The sarrafs (shroffs) who specialised in changing money, also specialised in dealing with hundis. In the process, they also acted as private banks as they lent money to nobles and kept their money too. By means of hundis, they created credit which supplemented the money in circulation.

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